

Note: To understand these symbols, turn your head counter-clockwise and look at them sideways. You should see little faces.

Typical examples:

Hey, guess what - I got my consulting assignment next Thursday! :)

I'm on my way to fame and fortune now! ;)

There are many more smileys than the one's mentioned. We'll leave it to you to find more.

Pause Equivalents

Imagine that you ask someone if you can turn the knob up to ten and a half. Suppose he says, "Well", then pauses for a long time, scratches his head, looks down at the floor, winces, grits his teeth, and says again, "Well", then pauses and says, "It might not explode." You'd get a sense of just how bad an idea it would be, while the text:

Well, it might not explode.

gives less information. Consider using lots of white space and typed-out vocalizations of "I'm thinking" sounds, as follows:

Weeeellllll.... errr hem.

Wellll, it *might* not explode.

Summary

It is difficult for most people to express emotion well in a short message. Fortunately, you can use a number of textual tricks to help convey the emotion:

- m Asterisks (for emphasis)
- m Capital letters
- m Punctuation